ALLY WEALTH

Keyword Research Starter Workbook

KEYWORDS • AUTHOR RESOURCE LIBRARY

A practical workbook for discovering reader-language search phrases, evaluating relevance and organising a focused keyword shortlist without relying on unsupported ranking promises.

GET SEEN. GROW YOUR INFLUENCE. BUILD YOUR LEGACY.

How to use this resource

This guide is designed as a practical working document. Read it in sequence or move to the section that addresses your immediate need. Use the prompts to record decisions, assign actions and identify questions that require further research.

A note on platform guidance

Retailer features, metadata options, community rules and promotional policies can change. Verify current requirements with the relevant platform before making changes or launching a campaign. This guide is educational and does not guarantee rankings, reviews, sales or other outcomes.

Your working principles

Be accurate. Put reader relevance before vanity metrics. Respect platform rules and community boundaries. Keep records of decisions. Measure what matters to your goals.

Contents

01. Start with reader language

02. Define the ideal reader

03. Map genre and subgenre terms

04. List themes and tropes

05. Build a seed phrase bank

06. Mine reader questions

07. Use competitor titles ethically

08. Separate author terms from reader terms

09. Long-tail phrases

10. Search intent

11. Relevance scoring

12. Specificity scoring

13. Competition observations

14. Avoid misleading phrases

15. Phrase clustering

16. Keyword-to-book fit

17. Metadata policy awareness

18. Backend field planning

19. Track source and date

20. Shortlist scoring sheet

21. Prioritisation matrix

22. Test one change at a time

23. Measure meaningful signals

24. Refresh the research

Section 01

Start with reader language

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about start with reader language. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 02

Define the ideal reader

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about define the ideal reader. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 03

Map genre and subgenre terms

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about map genre and subgenre terms. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 04

List themes and tropes

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about list themes and tropes. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 05

Build a seed phrase bank

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about build a seed phrase bank. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 06

Mine reader questions

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about mine reader questions. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 07

Use competitor titles ethically

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about use competitor titles ethically. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 08

Separate author terms from reader terms

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about separate author terms from reader terms. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 09

Long-tail phrases

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about long-tail phrases. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 10

Search intent

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about search intent. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 11

Relevance scoring

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about relevance scoring. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 12

Specificity scoring

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about specificity scoring. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 13

Competition observations

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about competition observations. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 14

Avoid misleading phrases

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about avoid misleading phrases. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 15

Phrase clustering

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about phrase clustering. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 16

Keyword-to-book fit

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about keyword-to-book fit. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 17

Metadata policy awareness

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about metadata policy awareness. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 18

Backend field planning

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about backend field planning. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 19

Track source and date

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about track source and date. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 20

Shortlist scoring sheet

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about shortlist scoring sheet. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 21

Prioritisation matrix

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about prioritisation matrix. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 22

Test one change at a time

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about test one change at a time. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 23

Measure meaningful signals

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about measure meaningful signals. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section 24

Refresh the research

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about refresh the research. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

_____

_____

_____

_____

Working worksheet

Use this page to turn the guide into an action plan. Keep the scope realistic and prioritise the work that most directly supports the reader experience.

Area	Your decision / notes
Current position	
Priority improvement	
Evidence to collect	
Action owner	
Target date	
How success will be reviewed	

Your next 30 days

Choose a small number of actions you can complete consistently. Avoid changing multiple variables at once when you need to understand what made a difference.

Week 1: Review and research

_____

_____

_____

Week 2: Make the priority improvements

_____

_____

_____

Week 3: Publish, test or implement

_____

_____

_____

Week 4: Review evidence and decide what comes next

_____

_____

_____

Further notes and questions